Chapter 1

Introduction to Microbiology

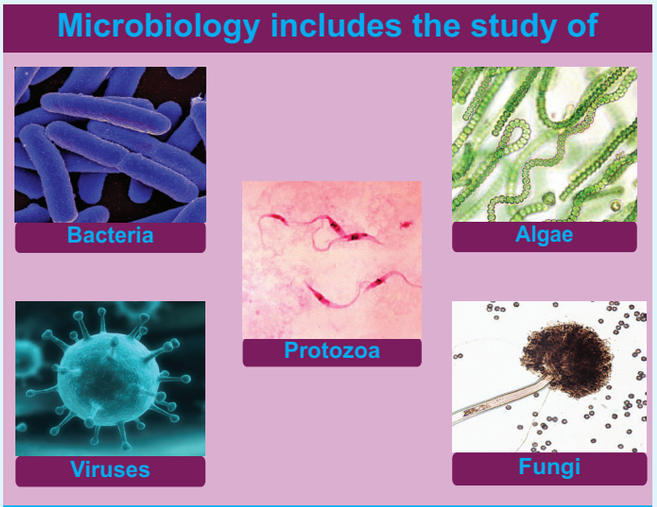
Chapter Outline

1.1 Groups of Microorganisms

1.2 Contributors to Microbiology

1.3 Branches of Microbiology

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Microorganisms - Bacteria, Fungi, Algae, Protozoa and Viruses - have been around for at least 3,500 million years. Microbes affect every aspect of life on earth. They have an amazing variety of shapes and sizes. They can exist in a wide range of habitats.

Science knows no country, because knowledge belongs to humanity, and is the torch which illuminates the world.

Louis Pasteur

Learning Objectives

After studying this chapter the student will be able,

- *To know the features of microorganisms.*
- *To know the contributions of different scientists.*
- *To know the branches of Microbiology.*

Microbiology is one of the fascinating fields of science. Microorganisms and their activities are the major concerns of society both nationally and internationally. The developments in biotechnology, genetic engineering and nanotechnology have placed Microbiology in the limelight. Microorganisms provide the model for interdisciplinary research and for studying fundamental life processes. There is growing recognition of microorganisms and their potential in many applied areas like Environmental science, Agriculture, Food and Pharmaceutical industries. The uses of microorganisms are becoming increasingly attractive. Some microorganisms are beneficial to human and cannot live without them.